



Foot-and-Mouth Disease in Cattle

Table of contents

1. [Economic implications of FMD](#)
2. [Etiology of FMD](#)
3. [Transmission of FMD](#)
4. [Symptoms of FMD](#)
5. [Treatment Of Foot-and-Mouth Disease :](#)
6. [Prevention of FMD](#)

Foot-and-Mouth Disease (FMD), also known as "खुरपका मुँहपका रोग," is a highly contagious viral disease affecting cloven-hoofed animals such as cattle, buffalo, sheep, goats, and pigs. It causes economic losses to livestock farmers, particularly impacting dairy and wool production.

Economic implications of FMD

- Disease is rarely fatal for adults, however the milk production, fertility in females and draft power of males are severely impaired for life after recovery from disease.
- Usually fatal in calves.
- Also affects sheep, goat (usually sub-clinically and are maintenance hosts) and pigs, which are amplification hosts (multiplies the virus around 3000 fold).

Etiology of FMD

- Caused by the Aphtho Virus from the Picornaviridae family.

Transmission of FMD

- A highly contagious viral disease that spreads through contact, contaminated water, feed and air.
- The virus is present in saliva, milk, urine, and feces of infected animals.

Symptoms of FMD



Tongue lesion



Dental pad lesion



Udder lesion

- Mouth ulcers causing reluctance to eat and drink.
- High fever (104°-106°F) lasting 2-6 days.
- Reduced milk production in cattle.
- Lesions and blisters between toes, causing lameness.
- Serious nasal discharge and excessive salivation.
- Vesicles may be seen on tongue, dental pad, lips, gums etc.
- Lesions on teat may lead to mastitis.
- Loss in condition may persist even after recovery.

Treatment Of Foot-and-Mouth Disease :

- No specific treatment for FMD. Treatment is only symptomatic, the disease will run its course.
- Emollients may be applied on lesions to soothe pain.
- Contact veterinarian for suitable advice

Prevention of FMD

- Vaccination of animals aged 4 months and above once in 6 months.
- Infected animals should be immediately separated since all excretions and secretions from infected animals contain the virus.
- All feed and fodder in contact with the infected animal should be destroyed.
- All equipment used should be cleaned and disinfected with 4% sodium carbonate solution or as suggested by a veterinarian.
- Healthy animals should not be handled by persons in contact with infected animals.
- The infected premises should be disinfected with 4% sodium carbonate solution or with the disinfectant suggested by a veterinarian.
- Vaccinating sheep, goat and pigs would control the disease to a better extend.
- Informing authorities promptly would enable them initiate control measures at the earliest which will help in limiting the spread of the disease.
- Avoid feeding milk from infected animals to calves.
- Strict hygiene measures, including hand sanitation before and after milking.

Related resources

1. [National Dairy Development Board](#)
2. [FMD -Clinical Signs, Its Prevention And Control - Krishi Vigyan Kendra Dimapur, ICAR](#)

source:

<https://data.vikaspedia.in/short/lc?k=VfhknMgYCSrt-Nuui73TUQ>

